Appendix 1

The Ramon Magsaysay Award

The Citation

NO SOCIAL RELATIONSHIP IN ASIA IS MORE FRAUGHT WITH AMBIGUITY than that between the police and the people. Called upon to maintain order and public safety, and to manage the region's paralysing traffic, the police provides essential civilizing services. Yet, nearly everywhere its reputation is tarnished by incompetence and abuses, large and small. For too many people, the police is not a positive good, only a necessary evil. Kiran Bedi, India's highest ranking female police officer and currently Delhi's inspector general of prisons, believes the police can do better.

Taught by her unconventional parents to compete and 'to think equally', Bedi excelled both at school and at tennis, the family passion. She sailed through college and [obtained] a masters degree and in 1972 … won the women's lawn tennis championship of Asia. That same year she entered the police academy and, in 1974, became the first woman to enter the elite Indian Police Service. Assigned to the capital city, Bedi rose rapidly in the ranks, winning national acclaim – and a presidential award – in 1978 by single-handedly driving off a band of club-and sword-wielding demonstrators with her police baton.

As deputy commissioner of police in Delhi's West and North Districts, Bedi posted constables in blue-and-white 'beat boxes' where citizens could consult them daily. She redirected former bootleggers to honest livelihoods by arranging friendly loans and assistance. Women's peace committees, set up at her initiative, promoted neighbourhood harmony. As community participation rose, crimes fell. Observing the link between drug addiction and chronic criminality, Bedi set up community-supported detoxification clinics, a model she later developed for wider application as deputy director of the Narcotics Control Bureau.

As New Delhi's traffic chief, her meticulous planning and ruthlessly impartial enforcement of the rules kept the capital's motley caravanserai of vehicles moving at the 1982 Asian Games – although she admits she made some enemies in the process.

In 1993 Bedi became inspector general of prisons (Delhi) and took charge of Tihar, India's largest prison complex. In this brutally overcrowded purgatory dwelled more than 8000 [actually 9500] prisoners, 90 per cent of whom were unconvicted and merely awaiting trial. Bedi rapidly transformed Tihar. Today its inmates follow a positive regimen of work, study and play. Illiterate prisoners learn to read and write. Others earn higher degrees from cooperating colleges. In prison workshops, prisoners keep their skills tuned and earn wages to save in Tihar's new bank. Through their *panchayats* (elected councils) inmates share responsibility for community discipline and for organizing games and entertainment. In yoga classes they learn meditation techniques to still anger and improve concentration. Complaints placed in the mobile petition box go directly to the top and are